

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 605

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to join with General Federation of Women's Clubs Ossoli Circle in celebrating March 2026 as Women's History Month.

WHEREAS, the month of March was officially designated as Women's History Month in 1987, and since that time, Women's History Month has provided an opportunity to recognize and celebrate the achievements, contributions, and resilience of women throughout history; and

WHEREAS, the accomplishments of women have advanced our society in countless fields, including education, science, business, government, the arts, and community leadership; and

WHEREAS, one group of impactful women that calls the Volunteer State home is the General Federation of Women's Clubs (GFWC) Ossoli Circle of Knoxville, the oldest Federated Women's Club in the South, founded on November 20, 1885; and

WHEREAS, as GFWC Ossoli Circle celebrates 140 years of service and history-making events, members are committed to remembering their foremothers and inspiring the next generation of women to foster a culture of equality, respect, and opportunity for all; and

WHEREAS, throughout the history of Tennessee and our nation, women have had and continue to have a tremendous impact; Tennessee women, in particular, directly impacted the passing of the 19th Amendment giving women the right to vote; and

WHEREAS, the vote that gave women the right to vote was cast in Tennessee by a man who was initially planning to vote against it; he changed his mind after reading a letter from his mother, an Ossoli Circle member; and

WHEREAS, the Knoxville Suffrage Coalition is at work to build the Suffrage Museum in Knoxville in order to do the important work of preserving a first-hand view of the role Tennessee women played in the Suffrage Movement; and

WHEREAS, it is vital that we support the achievements and progress of women, past and present, throughout the month of March and beyond, honoring their service and their commitment to a brighter, more equitable future for all citizens of this State and nation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we join with General Federation of Women's Clubs Ossoli Circle in celebrating March 2026 as Women's History Month, reflecting on the important role women have played—and continue to play—in shaping our shared history.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.